

March 16, 2026

CITY OF CONWAY
CITY COUNCIL MEETING
CONWAY CITY HALL
229 MAIN STREET, CONWAY
MONDAY, MARCH 16, 2026

PRESENT: Mayor Barbara Jo Blain, Mayor Pro Tem Beth Helms, Amanda Butler, William Goldfinch, Julie Hardwick, Justin Jordan, Larry White.

STAFF: Adam Emrick, City Administrator; Mary Catherine Hyman, Deputy City Administrator; June Wood, Public Information Officer; Jeff Leveille, Technology Services Director; Jason Perzan, Fire Chief; Reggie Jenerette, Solid Waste Director; Robert Cooper, Construction Services Director; Lynn Smith, Human Resource Director; Ted Dudley, Public Utilities Director; Jessica Hucks, Planning and Development Director; Brandon Harrelson, Public Works Director; Dale Long, Police Chief; Timmy Williams, Hospitality and Beautification Director; Ashley Smith, Parks and Recreation Director; Kelli Thomas, Deputy PIO; Bobby Wallace, Fleet Maintenance Director; Chris Weatherford, Public Utilities Deputy Director; and Alicia Shelley, City Clerk.

OTHERS: There were approximately 20 others in attendance.

CALL TO ORDER: Mayor Blain called the meeting to order.

INVOCATION/PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE: Butler gave the invocation and led the Pledge of Allegiance.

The requirements for posting notice of this meeting under South Carolina's Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) were met.

CONSENT AGENDA:

- A. Final Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-03-16 (A) to annex approximately 1+/- acres of property located at 3000 Hwy 378 (PIN 337-16-04-0011).**
- B. Final Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-03-16 (D) to rezone approximately 1.0+/- acres of property at 3000 Hwy 378 (PIN: 337-16-04-0011) from the Horry County Highway Commercial (HC) district to the City of Conway Highway Commercial (HC) district.**
- C. Final Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-03-16 (B) to annex approximately 0.43+/- acres of property located at 1322 & 1324 Cottage Lane (PINs 338-10-02-0005 & 338-10-02-0006).**
- D. Final Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-03-16 (E) to rezone approximately 0.43+/- acres of property at 1322 and 1324 Cottage Lane (PINs: 338-10-02-0005 & -0006) from the Horry County Highway Commercial (HC) district to the City of Conway Low/Medium-Density Residential (R-1) district, or alternatively, the City of Conway Highway Commercial (HC) district.**

- E. Final Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-03-16 (C) to annex approximately 0.2 +/- acres of property located at 1326 Cottage Lane (PIN 338-10-02-0007).**
- F. Final Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-03-16 (F) to rezone approximately 0.22+/- acres of property at 1326 Cottage Lane (PIN: 338-10-02-007) from the Horry County Highway Commercial (HC) district to the City of Conway Highway Commercial (HC) district.**
- G. Final Reading of Ordinance #2026-03-16 (G), an ordinance authorizing the relinquishment of an existing waterline easement and the acceptance of a new 30-foot-wide waterline easement associated with the relocation and upsizing of a City of Conway water transmission line related to Santee Cooper's substation project, owned by the South Carolina Public Service Authority (Santee Cooper) and identified as PINs 369-00-00-0050, 369-00-00-0027 and 369-00-00-0028.**
- H. Final Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-03-16 (H), an ordinance extending the non-exclusive franchise agreement issued to Randall's Culinary Creations Mobile Food Truck at the parking lot located at 7 Elm Street.**
- I. Approval of Protocol and MOU between Conway Police Department and South Carolina Department of Social Services**
- J. Approval of a Resolution accepting dedication of roadways & drainage and the financial guarantee for the roadway warranty for the Chapman Village subdivision (Hudson Trail, Eloise Lane, Caisa Court).**
- K. Approval of a Resolution Recognizing the need for the Horry County Solid Waste Authority to expand Landfill Capacity for Residents and Businesses within the City of Conway**
- L. Approval of February 17, 2026 City Council Meeting Minutes**
- M. Approval of March 5-6 Budget Retreat Meeting Minutes**

APPROVAL OF CONSENT AGENDA: Motion: White made a motion, seconded by Hardwick to approve the March 16, 2026 consent agenda. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

SPECIAL PRESENTATION:

- ~~**A. Presentation of Longevity Awards — February 2026 — 5 Years: Jonathan Brown, Police; 5 Years: Jacob Shook, Police; 5 Years: Matthew Micallef, Police; 25 Years: Darren Alston, Police.**~~
- ~~**B. Employee of the Month for March 2026 — Public Safety**~~

- C. Presentation of a Proclamation declaring March 2026 as Red Cross Month** – Blain presented the Proclamation declaring March 2026 as Red Cross Month to the representatives of the Red Cross that were in attendance.
- D. Update on Conway Senior Center** – Elaine Gore, Director of Horry County Council on Aging informed council of their interests in relocating from the City Senior Center to the fellowship hall at former Jamestown Baptist Church and are prepared to upgrade the fellowship hall following all necessary permission and codes. Gore said that they are prepared to continue to cover their own expenses and looks forward to discussing the proposal.
- E. Presentation by Resurrected Life Christian Outreach Ministry – Robin Wages** – not present.
- F. Presentation by Health Care Partners** – Josh Kay of Mashburn Construction introduced Santino Mayo, CEO of Health Care Partners who gave a brief overview of the services offered. Mayo announced the progress of their new facility and showed a rendering of the building coming soon to Fourth Avenue, Conway.

George Williams, board member of Health Care Partners, expressed his excitement about the new building and being able to serve the community. Williams said that they would like to expand the community garden to the adjacent parcel under the oak trees and asked the city to partner with the health center on this endeavor.

Kay announced all the partners involved in the project, thanked staff, gave a summary of the rendering of the building and the projected timeline.

Lee Belcher of First Citizens said they are honored to be a partner with Health Care Partners in this project.

FIRST READING:

- A. First Reading of Ordinance #2026-04-20 (C), an ordinance granting a distribution right-of-way easement to the South Carolina Public Service Authority (Santee Cooper) across property of the City of Conway adjacent to Sherwood Road (PIN 338-00-00-0024).** Harrelson stated that the McKeithan Watershed Project is approaching its final stages and planning is underway for landscaping, recreational features, and site lighting. Staff recommended the installation of Santee Cooper streetlights along the walkways, as well as electrical connections, to support seasonal and holiday decorations. The proposed fixtures would match the lighting currently used in nearby developments and throughout the downtown area, ensuring visual consistency and enhancing public safety. To proceed with this work, the city must grant Santee Cooper a distribution right-of-way. The required easement would extend the full length of the distribution lines and measure 20 feet in width and 110 feet on each side of the cable centerline. Establishing this easement provides the necessary clearance for energized lines, ensures access for maintenance vehicles, and protects utility infrastructure. The easement would be perpetual

and would authorize Santee Cooper to enter the property as needed to operate, maintain, and service its equipment. Harrelson said that easements are required of property owners within the subject work area, which includes the City of Conway for the property adjacent to Sherwood Road. Harrelson said that staff recommended first reading.

Motion: White made a motion, seconded by Butler to approve first reading of Ordinance #2026-04-20 (C) granting a distribution right-of-way easement to the South Carolina Public Service Authority (Santee Cooper) across property of the City of Conway adjacent to Sherwood Road. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

- B. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-05-04 (A) to annex approximately 0.73+/- acres of property located at 424 Maplewood Circle (PIN 324-06-01-0002).** Hucks stated that this item is a request to annex approximately .73 acres located at 424 Maplewood Circle. The current zoning is Horry County SF40, which is single family residential on lot sizes a minimum of 40,000 square feet. The parcel contains a single-family home and a detached garage. The applicant is requesting annexation in accordance with city ordinance regarding new connections to city utilities. The property is adjacent to parcels already located in the city limits, including properties to the side and rear. The future land use map designates this area as R-1, which is also consistent with the surrounding properties that are already in the city limits. Planning Commission will hold the public hearing on the proposed zoning upon annexation at their April 2 meeting and their recommendation will be forwarded for first reading of an ordinance regarding the appropriate zoning upon annexation. Hucks said that staff recommends approval of first reading of the ordinance to annex the subject property.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by White to approve first reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-05-04 (A) to annex the property located at 424 Maplewood Circle. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

- C. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-05-04 (B) to annex approximately 0.63+/- acres of property located at 1121 E Hwy 501 (PIN 367-14-03-0011).** Hucks stated that this property is currently zoned Horry County Highway Commercial and the property contains an older commercial building that is currently used as a tire center. Based on google imagery, the property has consistently been used as either a tire center or a small used car lot since the early 2000's. This property is owned by the same property owner of 1125 and 1135 E. Highway 501 (next request on the agenda), which has restrictive covenants and which triggered the annexation when the applicant applied for city utilities for that property, since all adjacent properties become subject to annexation upon the requirement of any property owned by the same applicant being subject to annexation. The city's future land use map identifies this property as Highway Commercial, which is consistent with the future land use map for surrounding properties with frontage along the Highway 501 corridor. This ordinance is for first reading of annexation only. If approved, Planning Commission will hold a public hearing on the proposed zoning upon annexation at their April 2 meeting. Hucks said that staff recommends approval of first reading of the ordinance to annex this property.

Motion: Jordan made a motion, seconded by Hardwick to approve first reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-05-04 (B) to annex the property located at 1121 E. Highway 501.
Vote: Unanimous. Motion carried.

- D. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-05-04 (C) to annex approximately 3.29+/- acres of property located at 1125 & 1135 E Hwy 501 (PIN 367-14-03-0008).** Hucks stated that this request is for annexation of the property located at 1125 and 1135 East Highway 501, which is adjacent to the previous property just discussed. This property contains the structure that triggered the annexation requirement. The property at 1135 E. Hwy 501 contains the commercial business, Skyline Signs and the property at 1125 E. Hwy 501 was previously a mobile home dealership until approximately 2017. According to county land records, the current property owners acquired the property at 1125 E. Hwy 501 in 2018, and the two parcels remained separate until 2022 when the county approved a plat combining them into a single tract. As a result, what were previously separate uses on individual parcels now exist on one combined property, including commercial businesses and a mobile home that was used residentially for several years. County records indicate that the mobile home was moved to its current location and registered in 2010, and the structure is currently vacant. The property owner is seeking annexation in accordance with city ordinance to reconnect the mobile home to city utilities, which has been disconnected since September of last year, with the intent of renting the structure as a residence.

Unlike the county's Highway Commercial district, the City's Highway Commercial zoning district does not permit residential uses, including manufactured or mobile homes. While limited residential uses are permitted under the county's version of Highway Commercial, manufactured homes are not, so it's unclear whether the residential structure was originally permitted under county regulations. Staff also noted that a new address of 1129 E. Hwy 501 has recently been assigned to the location of the mobile home, which was previously associated with the 1125 address.

Hucks said that if the property is annexed and assigned Highway Commercial zoning upon annexation, the structure would be considered nonconforming, and whether it could continue to be used residentially would depend on whether the use can be verified as a lawful pre-existing use prior to annexation, and how it is evaluated under the city's nonconforming use provisions. Aside from Skyline Signs, it appears that another business, Safeshield, which provides traffic control services, has equipment and materials stored on the portion of the property addressed as 1125 E. Hwy 501, although their website lists their business being located at 1135 E. Hwy 501. Currently, staff has not located a record of an active business license for the business at either address. If annexed, any businesses operating on the property would be required to comply with the city's business licensing and zoning regulations.

Hucks said that this request is for first reading of annexation only. If approved, Planning Commission will hold the required hearing on the proposed zoning upon annexation at their April 2 meeting and that staff supports annexation as it represents a logical extension of the city limits along the Highway 501 corridor and recommends approval of first reading,

There was some discussion regarding the zoning district requirements.

Motion: White made a motion, seconded by Blain to approve first reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-05-04 (C) to annex the property located at 1125 & 1135 E. Highway 501. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

- E. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-05-04 (D) to rezone an approximate 7.4-acre portion of 8.76+/- acres of property located at 2487 Hwy 501 E (PIN: 383-14-02-0001) from the Highway Commercial (HC) and Light Industrial (LI) districts to the Light Industrial (LI) district.** Hucks stated that this request is to rezone a portion of the property at 2487 Highway 501 E from Highway Commercial to Light Industrial. The property was originally annexed in 2006, and at that time, the parcel was assigned split-zoning, with the first approximately 300 feet along Highway 501 zoned HC and the remainder zoned LI. Since that time, amendments to the City's Unified Development Ordinance (UDO) included an amendment prohibiting split-zoning of parcels, except in limited cases involving environmentally sensitive areas. The property owner is currently proposing to subdivide a 1.36-acre portion from the parent tract that would retain the HC zoning and access to the existing business, Tyson Signs, on the LI zoned portion of the property. Staff found that allowing subdivision while keeping the existing zoning pattern would increase the degree of split-zoning condition, which would represent an expansion of nonconformity that is not permitted under the UDO. To resolve that issue, the applicant requested to rezone the remaining HC portion, minus the 1.36-acre portion proposed to be split from the parent tract, to LI, which would eliminate the split zoning and result in a single zoning designation across the parcel following subdivision.

Hucks said that Planning Commission held the public hearing on the request at their March 5 meeting and recommended approval of the request. Hucks said that staff also recommended approval.

Motion: White made a motion, seconded by Helms to approve first reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-05-04 (D) to rezone the property located at 2487 Highway 501 E. **Vote:** Helms, Butler, White, Jordan, Hardwick and Blain voted yes. Goldfinch voted no. Motion carried with a 6-1 vote.

CONSIDERATION:

- A. Consideration of approval of the proposed subdivision name, "Oak Haven," for a new development located on Westridge Boulevard (PIN 337-13-03-0056).** Hucks stated that this proposed development is located on Westridge Blvd, off Highway 378 across from the Holt Gardens development and next to the Westridge subdivision. The proposed development will consist of 10 single-family dwellings on one common property. Plans are currently being reviewed by TRC; however, the ordinance requires city council approval of the proposed subdivision name prior to final plan approval. Hucks said that staff recommended approval of the proposed name Oak Haven.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Helms to approve the subdivision name of Oak Haven for a new development located on Westridge Blvd. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

- B. Consideration of a Request for Proposal (RFP) to conduct an Employee Classification and Pay Study.** L. Smith stated that this was a consideration of a RFP to conduct an Employee Classification and Pay Study to review the city's current employee classification structure and compensation system. The RFP opening was held on March 4, 2026 and 7 proposals were received. L. Smith said that staff recommended awarding the contract to Evergreen Solutions with the amount of \$59,500.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by White to approve staff's recommendation to award the contract to Evergreen Solutions. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

- C. Consideration of a Special Event – Spring Fest @ the Outpost - April 18, 2026.** Emrick informed council that The Conway Outpost is proposing to host Springfest on April 18, 2026 which will consist of a vendor and food tuck event with 60-80 vendors with 10x10 tents. The applicant is requesting to close off a portion of the parking lot at the marina, and it is the same day as the Horry Electric 5K. Emrick was concerned about the likelihood of heavy boat user traffic in mid-April.

The applicant, Shannon Jordan further explained the request stating that the dock would not be closed and that the back parking lot would be used for the Marina parking.

Emrick stated that he would put them in contact with Horry Electric to avoid any potential conflicts.

Motion: Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by Blain to approve the special event as presented. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

PUBLIC INPUT: None

CITY ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT:

Emrick informed Council of the following:

- Reminder of the Recreation Department holding the State's Largest Easter Egg Hunt on March 28th. Separate hunts for children of all ages and abilities will take place.
- The City of Conway sponsored Coastal Baseball game is Friday, the 20. Emrick said he hopes to see all of council there in Teal supporting our Nationally ranked home team and you don't want to miss Justin Jordan is throwing out the first pitch at the game.
- Staff will be meeting with the Department of Environmental Services later this week to look at Lake Busbee to assess whether there are any invasive plant species out there that need to be addressed. This is part of a larger effort to support native bird habitats at the Lake.
- The Mayor's Youth Council plans to begin painting their mural at Riverfront Park this week.

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- The second class of the Citizens Academy starts March 25. Space is available for this class, which runs for 8 weeks and takes place on Wednesdays from 2 p.m. until 4 p.m.
- A couple of weeks ago, the city was presented with a monetary gift from the Estate of Carol and David Hoyt. Carol and Dave lived on Laurel Street and while they only were residents of Conway for a few years, they certainly made their mark on many. Carol spoke before this Council several times, advocating for upgrades for the Conway Dog Park. The gift to the city was to further her work. Her gift will add an arched “Conway” entrance into the Dog Park and will provide additional shade trees to be planted at the park.

COUNCIL INPUT:

White

- Invited Health Care Partners to be a part of the community garden on Racepath Street

Goldfinch

- Would like to revisit Public Input during Council meetings in a workshop in the future.
- Asked if there was a mechanism for folks that want to donate such as CCU who have a whole staff that is committed to raising money for their various programs. Emrick said that it was discussed at retreat to bring in a RFP or RFQ to bring in a third-party consultant to work on sponsorships for the city on events, activities and naming rights.
- Said that Emrick’s book was fantastic and should be a requirement as a new citizen to read.

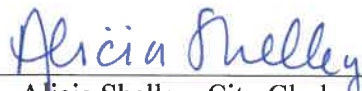
Hardwick

- Asked city staff to possibly work OT picking up illegal signs along Main Street that developers and such are leaving out over the weekends.
- Attended the Investiture Ceremony of Dr. Winebrake at CCU and was glad that the city was included in this celebration.
- Asked staff to remember dog and human fountains while working out at the Dog Park. Emrick stated that the fountains arrived on Friday.
- Said that Conway has heart. Hardwick then told a story of her volunteering with some ladies on Friday and found out that they volunteered the city to help with the decorations. Hardwick said that the comment from them was, “The city provided us an opportunity to become a volunteer and work with the decorations, but what they gave us was family as we are now family and we are now sisters.” Hardwick hopes that council, staff and the city continues to have heart.

WORKSHOP: None

ADJOURNMENT: Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by White, to adjourn the meeting.
Vote: Unanimous. Motion carried.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES: Minutes approved by City Council this 20 day of April, 2026.


Alicia Shelley, City Clerk